THE SHIFT

Commerce is moving inside the AI apps consumers already use.

OpenAI now hosts dedicated **ChatGPT Apps** that let users discover, compare, and shop a retailer's catalog directly inside the chat. Google is building branded shopping into Gemini through its **Business Agent.** Perplexity has made conversational checkout native. For retailers, this is not a feature to watch. It is a new storefront to show up in.

ChatGPT Apps Ecosystem ↗ | Google Business Agent ↗ | Google AI Mode Shopping ↗ | Perplexity Shopping ↗

THE SIGNAL

~69%

of AI assistant usage in the US goes through ChatGPT

StatCounter, 2026 ↗

84M

shopping questions per week on ChatGPT in the US

Stackline, Nov 2025 ↗

66%

of shoppers ready to use AI assistants to help them buy online

Retail Technology Review, Feb 2026 ↗

WHY GROCERY

Grocery shoppers arrive in chat with a need, not a search query. They come higher in the funnel, where the AI does the reasoning: breaking the need into products, suggesting alternatives, identifying cross-sell opportunities, and building a broader basket. **That is why grocery is already one of the most active early categories in AI commerce.**

Walmart
ChatGPT App + Gemini Agent
Mar 2026
↗ geekseller ↗ walmart.com

TARGET
ChatGPT App
Nov 2025
↗ target.com

Loblaws
ChatGPT App, Canada
Feb 2026
↗ loblaw.ca

Carrefour
ChatGPT App, France
Mar 2026
↗ connexion

+35% bigger baskets for AI-assisted grocery shoppers at Walmart. Modern Retail, Feb 2026 ↗

FISHBONE

Connecting retailers' commerce ecosystems to the AI platforms consumers consolidate around.

Consumers increasingly use AI assistants as personal butlers, for planning, research, and purchasing. The trend is consolidation toward these platforms. Fishbone connects a retailer's brand, voice, and catalog into this shift so they show up where customers are already shopping, enabling everything from product discovery and retrieval to basket construction to checkout, all on top of the retailer's existing infrastructure. Nothing gets replaced. The grocer stays in control.

We start where the momentum is strongest: ChatGPT Apps, the most mature instance of this shift, expanding across other AI surfaces as they emerge.

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